

# Gabriella Aboulafia

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## EDUCATION

### Harvard University

2027 (*expected*)*PhD in Health Policy (Political Analysis track)*

Dissertation: Essays on Health Policy and Politics in the United States

Committee: Benjamin Sommers (*chair; Harvard Health Policy*), Andrea Campbell (*MIT Political Science*), Adrianna McIntyre (*Harvard Health Policy*), Daniel Schneider (*Harvard Public Policy & Sociology*)

### Harvard Kennedy School of Government

2023

*Master in Public Policy*

### University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

2019

*BS in Public Health with Distinction, Department of Health Policy and Management*

## PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Aboulafia, Gabriella, Jonathan Gruber, and Benjamin D. Sommers. “[The Rise and Fall \(and Rise\) of the Affordable Care Act: Varying Impacts on Coverage Over Time and Place](#),” *Journal of Health Economics* 2026;110:103188.

\* Cited in an amicus brief in *City of Columbus v. Kennedy* (4th Cir. 2026), challenging ACA enrollment restrictions

\* Covered by *Bloomberg*

Aboulafia, Gabriella, Amanda Chen, and David Grabowski. “[Asset Spend-Down and Medicaid Enrollment in Nursing Homes](#),” *JAMA Netw Open* 2025;8(12):e2546876.

\* Cited in a letter by Senate Finance Committee members proposing long-term care reforms (2026)

Aboulafia, Gabriella and Daniel Schneider. “[Employer-Sponsored Health Insurance for Workers in the Hourly Service Sector](#),” *JAMA Health Forum* 2025;6(11):e254747.

Aboulafia, Gabriella and Adrianna McIntyre. “[How Should Children’s Medicaid Eligibility Be Monitored?](#),” *AMA J Ethics* 2025;27(9):E686-694.

Smith, Rebecca B., Gabriella Aboulafia, and Benjamin D. Sommers. “[Who Enrolls in Coverage and Who Remains Uninsured? Medicaid Take-Up Before and After the Affordable Care Act and During Unwinding](#),” *The Milbank Quarterly* 2025;103(2):349-389.

McIntyre, Adrianna, Benjamin D. Sommers, Gabriella Aboulafia, E. John Orav, Arnold M. Epstein, and Jose F. Figueroa. “[Experiences with Medicaid Unwinding Among Low-Income Adults in 4 Southern States](#),” *Health Affairs Scholar* 2025;3(5):qxaf083.

McIntyre, Adrianna, Benjamin D. Sommers, Gabriella Aboulafia, Jessica Phelan, E. John Orav, Arnold M. Epstein, and Jose F. Figueroa. “[Coverage and Access Changes During Medicaid Unwinding: A Survey of Low-Income Households in Four Southern States](#),” *JAMA Health Forum* 2024;5(6):e242193.

McIntyre, Adrianna, Gabriella Aboulafia, and Benjamin D. Sommers. “[Preliminary Data on Unwinding Continuous Medicaid Coverage](#),” *N Engl J Med* 2023;389:2215-2217.

## WORKS IN PROGRESS

Scheduling Volatility as a Barrier to Medicaid Work Requirement Compliance Among Service-Sector Workers (Revise and Resubmit at *Health Affairs*, with Benjamin Sommers, Daniel Schneider, and Adrianna McIntyre)

The Electoral Feedbacks of Medicare in an Era of Privatization (with Adrianna McIntyre)

Trends in Political Advertising of Health Issues from 2012–2022 (with Nolan Kavanagh and Adrianna McIntyre)

The Political Consequences of the Enhanced Marketplace Subsidies Expiration (with Adrianna McIntyre)

Tort Immunity and Nursing Home Outcomes (with Deepon Bhaumik, David Grabowski, and Jill Horwitz)

## SELECTED OTHER WRITING

Aboulafia, Gabriella, Jonathan Gruber, and Benjamin D. Sommers. “The Past and Future of Medicaid and the Affordable Care Act—Support or Sabotage?,” *JAMA* 2025;334(2):115-118.

Aboulafia, Gabriella. “Could Medicaid Losses Dampen Voter Turnout?,” *Tradeoffs Research Corner*, Nov. 6, 2023.

Aboulafia, Gabriella. “Opinion: Texas children at risk as pandemic-era Medicaid coverage ends,” *Austin American-Statesman*, Jul. 23, 2023.

Collins, Sara R., Munira Z. Gunja, and Gabriella N. Aboulafia. “U.S. Health Insurance Coverage in 2020: A Looming Crisis in Affordability—Findings from the Biennial Health Insurance Survey,” Survey brief, *Commonwealth Fund*, Aug. 2020.

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Fellow for GHHP 99: Global Health and Health Policy Capstone with Prof. David Cutler (Harvard College). *Taught 12 undergraduate students in a required weekly seminar.* Spring 2026

Primary Instructor for HLTHPOL 3020: Graduate Reading Course for Political Analysis (Harvard GSAS). *Taught four doctoral students in a required weekly seminar.* Spring 2026

Teaching Fellow for 17.30: Making Public Policy with Prof. Andrea Campbell (MIT). *Taught 18 undergraduate students in a required weekly section.* Fall 2025

Teaching Fellow for API 201: Quantitative Analysis and Empirical Methods I with Profs. Jonathan Borck and Teddy Svoronos (Harvard Kennedy School). *Taught 20+ master’s students in an optional weekly review session.* Fall 2024, Fall 2025

Course Assistant for API 201 with Profs. Jonathan Borck, Sharad Goel, and Teddy Svoronos. *Held weekly office hours for students and graded problem sets and exams.* Fall 2023

## FELLOWSHIPS, HONORS AND AWARDS

Fellow, Economic Security Project. *Yearlong fellowship to co-develop a policy brief for policymakers considering a federal public option health insurance program.* 2026-

James M. and Cathleen D. Stone PhD Scholar in Inequality and Wealth Concentration, Stone Program in Wealth Distribution, Inequality, and Social Policy (Harvard University). *Selected as one of 10 Harvard doctoral students in the social sciences to receive a yearlong dissertation writing stipend.* 2024-

Fellow, Center for American Politics (Harvard University) 2024-

Distinction in Student Teaching Award (Harvard Kennedy School) 2025, 2026

AHRQ T32 Kirschstein National Research Service Award Trainee 2023-2025

Dean’s Award for Excellence in Student Teaching (Harvard Kennedy School) 2023

Graduate Prize Fellowship (Harvard University). *Recognizes a select group of prospective PhD students who show exceptional promise to expand the diversity of experience and thought on Harvard’s campus.* 2023

Winston Health Policy Scholar. *Scholarship award that recognizes excellence and achievement for students in master’s degree programs in health administration, health policy, and public health.* 2022

Harvard Kennedy School Malcolm Wiener Center for Social Policy’s Policy Analysis Grant Award. *To conduct research for Policy Analysis Exercise (MPP capstone).* 2022

## REFeree SERVICE

*Health Affairs, Health Affairs Scholar, Health Services Research, JAMA Health Forum, Journal of Health Economics, Journal of Health Politics, Policy, and Law*

## RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

Graduate Student Representative, Health Politics and Policy Section of APSA 2026-

Methods and Data Council, AcademyHealth 2023-2025

Annual Research Meeting Abstract Reviewer, AcademyHealth 2024

## PROFESSIONAL RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

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|                                                                                                                                                              |             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Research Assistant, David Grabowski (Harvard Medical School)                                                                                                 | 2024-       |
| Research Assistant, Adrianna McIntyre (Harvard TH Chan School of Public Health)                                                                              | 2022-       |
| Research Assistant, Austin Frakt (Harvard TH Chan School of Public Health)                                                                                   | 2022-2024   |
| Research Assistant, Jose Figueroa (Harvard TH Chan School of Public Health)                                                                                  | 2022-2024   |
| Special Assistant to the Assistant Secretary for Legislation (Office of the Assistant Secretary for Legislation, US Department of Health and Human Services) | Summer 2022 |
| Program Assistant, Health Care Coverage and Access (The Commonwealth Fund)                                                                                   | 2019-2021   |

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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| “Federalism in Practice: State Policy Discretion and Coverage and Market Outcomes in the ACA,” APPAM <i>(panel speaker)</i>                                                                                                                                                                         | 2026 ( <i>upcoming</i> ) |
| “The Rise and Fall (and Rise) of the Affordable Care Act,” APSA Health Policy and Politics Section Mini Conference <i>(poster)</i>                                                                                                                                                                  | 2025                     |
| “COVID-19 Policy and Work-Related Inequality,” APPAM <i>(panel speaker)</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | 2024                     |
| “Health, Health Care Costs, and Attitudes Towards Government,” APSA Annual Meeting <i>(panel speaker)</i>                                                                                                                                                                                           | 2024                     |
| “Pandemic-Era Coverage Changes and Health Insurance Inequality Among Service-Sector Workers,” (with Daniel Schneider) AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting. <i>Selected as one of two student papers to be presented on a panel at the State Health Policy Research Interest Group discussion.</i> | 2024                     |
| “Disruptions in Coverage and Economic Adversity: Findings from a Survey of Adults with Low Incomes,” AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting <i>(poster)</i>                                                                                                                                          | 2024                     |

## MEDIA MENTIONS

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| Jarvis, L, “ <a href="#">The Quiet Obamacare Overhaul Needs a Loud Reveal.</a> ” <i>Bloomberg Opinion</i> , July 24, 2025.                                          |
| Denean, A, “ <a href="#">Millions losing Medicaid coverage over missed calls, paperwork and confusion about rules.</a> ” <i>The National Desk</i> , August 9, 2023. |
| Klibanoff, E, “ <a href="#">500,000 Texans have been dropped from the Medicaid rolls since April.</a> ” <i>Texas Tribune</i> , July 17, 2023.                       |
| Mastroianni, B, “ <a href="#">Millions May Lose Medicaid Coverage, Here’s How to Check Your Status.</a> ” <i>Health</i> , March 15, 2023.                           |